



How do seeds grow?

Plants are rooted to the spot, so to reproduce and spread, flowering plants make seeds from which new plants grow. A seed contains a tiny young plant called an embryo, which lies dormant (inactive) until it senses the perfect conditions to germinate and grow into a new plant.

The right conditions

Seeds need ideal conditions—warmth, air, and water—to germinate. Some need darkness to sense they are properly buried. Others need light to know they are not buried too deep.



Young shoot > Next, a young shoot emerges from the seed, growing upward until it breaks out of the soil. It quickly begins to make food using sunlight.

Germination > A seed lies dormant until it detects moisture and warmth. It then absorbs water from the soil, and the seed springs to life, in a process known as germination.

First root > Most seeds begin germination by sending a root downward into the soil. The root absorbs water and nutrients from the soil and passes them on to the developing shoot.

